proved eminently by the sincere and instantaneous reaction and sympathy voiced by them in public meetings held on the occasions of the passing away of prominent Indian leaders. The Indian shops were all closed and condolence messages came pouring

in—this in addition to the public meetings, held all over the islands. In fact, it is understood that several Indians here offered to join the army in defence of India at the time of the Pakistan aggression.

Shekhawat flagged an old secret report to argue why it was imperative for R&AW to act for Indians in Fiji. According to the report the Fijian Indians expected support from the Indian government in cultural, religious and educational matters. The report also said:

The vested interests of Europeans and Australians who have in recent years gained the implicit confidence of the Fijians by the good old policy of divide & rule and by dangling before the Fijian community the dangers of Indian domination, are always extremely uncomfortable whenever the discussions in the United Nations take place regarding Fiji or when this international body passes resolutions with a view to furthering the cause of freedom and democracy in these islands. The natural mouthpiece of this group—The Fiji Times—goes into convulsions whenever United Nations criticizes the unreasonable and unfair features of Fiji's constitution and seeks to remedy the state of affairs here by sending a United Nations delegation or

by demanding a target date to be fixed for the freedom of these Islands. People of Indian origin have really made a preserving